Incidental Adulterants

Incidental adulterants are found in food substances due to ignorance, negligence or lack of proper facilities. It is not a wilful act on the part of the adulterer. E.g.. Pesticides, droppings of rodents, larvae in food.

The common adulterants are

Milk is adulterated with water, chalk, urea, caustic soda and skimmed milk. Khoya is adulterated with paper, refined oil and skimmed milk powder.



Plate 5.4 Milk

Pure Honey is often adulterated with several types of standard sugar solution, glucose, fructose, sucrose and also with cheap syrups, corn, inverted sugar and cane sugar.



Plate 5.5 Honey

Turmeric powder is adulterated with 'metanil yellow'. 'Metanil yellow' is produced utilizing some raw materials like 'metanilic acid' and 'diphenylamine'. The risk of consuming turmeric powder mixed with 'metanil yellow' is that it is purely carcinogenic – means it is capable of causing cancer in living tissues.



Plate 5.6 Spices

In **black pepper,** the adulterant used is papaya seeds to add bulk. The harmful effect is that papaya seeds can cause serious liver problems, stomach disorders, severe glaucoma and epidemic dropsy.

Chilli powder is often adulterated with a similar looking substance like brick powder.

Ginger is used widely in culinary practice in India in the fresh or dry form. Dry ginger is often coated with blue coloured dye ultramarine blue to prevent insect infestation. It is an inorganic pigment used as laundry whitener.

In **Ice cream** the adulterant is pepper oil, ethyl acetate, butraldehyde and washing powder that are not less than poison. Pepper oil is used as a pesticide and ethyl acetate causes terrible diseases affecting lungs, kidneys and heart.

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